### Needle Threader

Needle threader is a small metal which has a small flexible loop through which thread is passed through. The loop is then passed through the eye of the needle to thread the needle. It is very useful for elderly people.

### Bodkin

Bodkin is a variation of needle with a large eye on one side and blunt edge on the other side. It is used to insert or pull cords, tapes or ribbons through casings.

***Example :*** To insert cord in sari petticoat.

### Loop Turner

Loop turner is a long metal with a hook at one end and a circle at the other end. It is used to turn bias tubing to the right side.

***Example :*** Fabric loops.

## 6.7 PRESSING / IRONING TOOLS

Pressing is the process of removing wrinkles from stitched garments. Pressing or ironing is the last step in dress designing. It is very important because it results in a neat finish and enhances the look of the garment. The most common pressing tools are iron box, iron board, sleeve board, seam roll and press cloth (Figure 6.6).

### Iron Box

Iron box is made up of metal (Aluminium, steel or copper). It is heated with charcoal. Today Teflon coated iron boxes are available. This is heated by steam. Electrical iron box is the best for ironing.

### Iron Board

For ironing special boards are also available in shop. They have padded tops, covered with suitable fabric. This helps in ironing. The height varies based upon the height of the user. It should be kept in a perfect place without any ups and downs in the board.

### Sleeve Board

Sleeve board is used to iron the narrow parts and sleeves. It is similar to an iron board.

### Seam Roll

Seam roller is a soft cushioned oval shaped board. It is used for ironing the small parts in a garment. Ironing, helps to press down the seam allowance on wrong side of the fabric.

### Press Cloth

Press cloth is a fabric piece which is used to press the garment to be ironed in a damp condition. This fabric shall be colour fast without starch.



Iron Box



Iron Board



Sleeve Board

Figure 6.6 Pressing / Ironing Tools



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